

Volume Light

One way to make lights more visible is to use volume light, which simulates the effect of light through a dusty or smoky room. Volume light can be used on spotlights, direct lights, or omni lights. Fog in a spotlight takes up a cone shape, but omni light fog can have a specific radius and falloff, for creating fog in a specific volume.

Lens Effects

Many times you need to make a light source visible. To do so, you use 3ds Max's Lens Effects, a suite of effects that allow you to add effects such as glow, halos, and lens flares to a light. Like Volume Lights, Lens Effects are added by using the Atmospheres & Effects rollout in the light's Modify panel. The Lens Effects main window has tools to globally control the size of the effect as well as to render tests.

Setting Light Exclusion

Light exclusion gives you precise control over lighting on an object-by-object basis. Lists of objects can be excluded from a specific light or can be included. This gives you many ways to customize how lights affect the scene. The window is accessed by clicking the Exclude button on the light's General Parameters rollout. 